

MILAN-CORTINA  OLYMPICS



ROBERT GAUTHIER Los Angeles Times
U.S. SPEEDSKATERS Mia Manganello, left, and Greta Myers unite after a third-place finish Saturday.

Tariffs refund process won't be simple

A mix of agencies and courts will decide how to return money to affected importers.

By PAUL WISEMAN

WASHINGTON — As the Supreme Court struck down President Trump's biggest tariffs, the justices left a \$133-billion question unanswered: What's going to happen to the money the government has already collected in import taxes now declared unlawful?

Companies have been lining up for refunds. But the way forward could prove chaotic.

When the smoke clears, trade lawyers say, importers are likely to get money back — eventually. “It's going to be a bumpy ride for a while,” said trade lawyer Joyce Ade-tutu, a partner at the Vinson & Elkins law firm.

As the contours of the challenge begin to take shape, Trump on Saturday announced he planned to increase to 15% from 10% the new tariffs he announced after his Supreme Court defeat, using a different legal [See Refunds, A7]

Companies brace

World leaders, firms gird for the latest swing in U.S. duties. **WORLD, A2**

New tariff at 15%

Trump says he's increasing duties from 10% after court defeat. **NATION, A6**

CIAO, ITALIA: A TALE OF TWO HOST CITIES

Breathtaking scenery, shattered records and some controversy marked the Winter Games

By Kevin Baxter

MILAN — William Shakespeare didn't attend the Milan-Cortina Winter Games, having died more than 400 years before they began. But he did use Italy as a backdrop in more than a third of his plays including “Romeo and Juliet,” which he set in Verona, transforming a city once known for violent feuds between noble families into a locale synonymous with romance.

And his lament over the pain of farewells probably will be felt by many of the athletes gathering Sunday for the Olympic closing ceremony at Arena di Verona, a 1st century Roman amphitheater.

The Milan-Cortina Games were the first Winter Olympics to feature two host cities, and it will become the first to have the opening and closing ceremony at different sites. In between, everyone seemed to have a good time.

“It's a lot of fun,” American pairs skater Danny O'Shea said. “Skating on Olympic ice is literally dreams coming true. [It's] been an amazing experience.”

“It's been everything and more,” U.S. figure skater Isabeau Levito added. “I don't think there's anything not to enjoy.” [See Olympics, A7]

MORE COVERAGE: U.S. bobsledder wins historic medal. **SPORTS, D8**

Colbert, Trump and the rule making broadcasters nervous

FCC uses an arcane provision to target TV stations in the president's crosshairs.

By STEPHEN BATTAGLIO

It was an extraordinary media moment: CBS late-night host Stephen Colbert on Tuesday publicly blasted his own employer over its handling of his interview with Democratic U.S. Senate candidate James Tar-larico of Texas.

Colbert contended that his own network prevented him from airing the interview Monday in an effort to appease the Trump administration, which CBS has denied. He chose instead to put the sit-down with the Texas state legislator on YouTube,

which is not regulated by the FCC.

The standoff not only highlighted the simmering tensions inside CBS with the late-night host, but also marked the latest flash point in the ongoing clash between the Trump administration and leading media and entertainment figures — including other late-night hosts Seth Meyers and Jimmy Kimmel — who have been openly critical of the president's policies.

Federal Communications Commission Chairman Brendan Carr has been leading the administration's efforts, aggressively attempting to wield the long dormant equal-time rules requiring broadcast TV stations to offer equal time to opposing candidates as a means of influencing the legacy media companies that

President Trump says treat him unfairly.

Carr contends that the effort is a long overdue corrective to combat what he and Trump believe is liberal bias in broadcast network news coverage. He has even threatened to pull TV station licenses if programmers don't get in line.

Last fall, he warned ABC that it could lose its TV station licenses after Kimmel made remarks on his program about slain right-wing activist Charlie Kirk that upset conservatives. Two major TV station groups pulled the program and the network suspended Kimmel's program for a week.

But experts say the efforts — along with the recent arrest of former CNN journalist Don Lemon over civil rights charges — pose a [See Equal time, A14]

County seeks change over sex abuse payouts

Officials urge state legislators to revisit law that opened path for costly litigation.

By REBECCA ELLIS

At a luncheon last week for L.A. County politicians, Supervisor Kathryn Barger pitched what she framed as a common-sense reform.

Legislators in Sacramento, she argued, need to change a 2019 law that extended the statute of limitations for sex abuse lawsuits, opening the floodgates for decades-old claims that have cost the county nearly \$5 billion and counting in payouts.

“I want them in Sacramento to fix it,” she said. “I have to believe that we are the tip of the iceberg.”

The controversial law, Assembly Bill 218, has led to thousands of claims over abuse that took place in schools, juvenile halls and foster homes. Supporters

say it continues to give survivors a chance at justice, while Barger and other officials warn the cost of the litigation is driving local governments to the brink of bankruptcy.

Rolling back AB 218, critics argue, is the single most obvious thing state lawmakers can do this legislative session.

The push has gained momentum amid concerns of fraud in the first of two payouts approved last year by L.A. County officials. At \$4 billion, it was the largest sex abuse settlement in U.S. history, with the money set aside for more than 11,000 victims.

The Times reported last fall on allegations of fabricated claims filed by plaintiffs within the settlement, which prompted L.A. County Dist. Atty. Nathan Hochman to open an investigation. Hochman told the supervisors last week that his office is reviewing “thousands of claims” for fraudulent submissions and pre-foster homes. Supporters [See AB 218, A8]

Democrats fear a splintered vote

Many worry a packed field in governors race could open door to a surprise GOP win.

By SEEMA MEHTA AND NICOLE NIXON

SAN FRANCISCO — Leaders of the California Democratic Party, along with liberal activists and loyal power brokers, are openly expressing fear that their crowded field of candidates running for governor may splinter the vote and open the door to a surprise Republican victory in November.

Because of those concerns, the Democrats lagging at the bottom of the pack are being urged to drop out of the race to ensure that the party's political dominance in statewide elections survives the 2026 election.

“California Democrats are prepared to do what's re-

quired,” state party chairman Rusty Hicks told reporters at the California Democratic Party's annual convention on Friday. “We are ready and willing and able to do what's required ... to ensure we have a strong candidate coming out of the primary to do what's required in November.”

Nine prominent Democrats are running to replace termed-out Gov. Gavin Newsom, compared with two top GOP candidates, and could divide the Democratic electorate enough that the two Republicans could receive the most votes in the June primary and advance to the November election. Under California's “jungle primary” system, the top two vote-getters advance to the general election, regardless of their party affiliation.

Hicks was deferential to the Democratic candidates who have long served in public office and have compelling personal tales and the [See Field, A8]



ALLEN J. SCHABEN Los Angeles Times

EXPANDING SANDS

Despite climate effects, California's beaches, including those in Huntington Beach, have grown 500 acres over 40 years. **CALIFORNIA, B1**

Immigration agent killed man

Circumstances were undisclosed by authorities of U.S. citizen shot during a traffic stop in Texas. **NATION, A4**

Weather

Mostly sunny. L.A. Basin: 76/56. **B7**

Business **A12**
Opinion Voices **A16**

Fire victims cite being ignored

Homeowners assert regulators did little to resolve State Farm claims. **BUSINESS, A12**

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For more than a century, South Los Angeles has been an anchor for Black art, activism and commerce — from the 1920s when Central Avenue was the epicenter of the West Coast jazz scene to recent years as artists and entrepreneurs reinvigorate the area with new developments such as Destination Crenshaw.

Now, the region's legacy is receiving formal recognition as a Black cultural district, a landmark move that aims to preserve South L.A.'s rich history and stimulate economic growth. State Sen. Lola Smallwood-Cuevas (D-Los Angeles), who led the effort, helped secure \$5.5 million in state funding to support the project, and in December the state agency California Arts Council voted unani-

Potential sites for new South L.A. monument

By Kailyn Brown



GENARO MOLINA Los Angeles Times

A 2024 Kwanzaa parade in Los Angeles' Crenshaw District, one possible location for the monument.

mously to approve the designation. The district, formally known as the Historic South Los Angeles Black Cultural District, is now one of 24 state-designated cultural districts, which also includes the newly added Black Arts Movement and Business District in Oakland.

Prior to this vote, there were no state designations that recognized the Black community — a realization that made Smallwood-Cuevas jump into action.

“It was very frustrating for me to learn that Black culture was not included,” said Smallwood-Cuevas, who represents South L.A. Other cultural districts include L.A.'s Little Tokyo and San Diego's Barrio Logan [See Monument, A10]